

TRUSTMRR · 1,000-ROW DATASET · FROZEN 30 JUL 2026

What 1,000 Startups Reveal About Real Revenue

A data story on where value actually concentrates, what the numbers hide, and what an investor should do next.

1,000

companies tracked

29

data points each

\$13.5M

combined MRR

One Snapshot, Four Ways to Measure Revenue

TrustMRR profiles indie and micro-SaaS startups pulled straight from their own payment providers — this is self-reported, provider-verified revenue, not survey data.



Revenue, 4 horizons

30-day, 3-month, 12-month, and all-time revenue, plus MRR and its 30-day growth rate



Business signals

Active subscriptions, X followers, domain rating, site visitors, revenue per visitor



Positioning text

Value proposition, problem solved, target persona, pricing model, category tags



Deal-readiness

Whether the company is listed for sale, its asking price, and implied revenue multiple

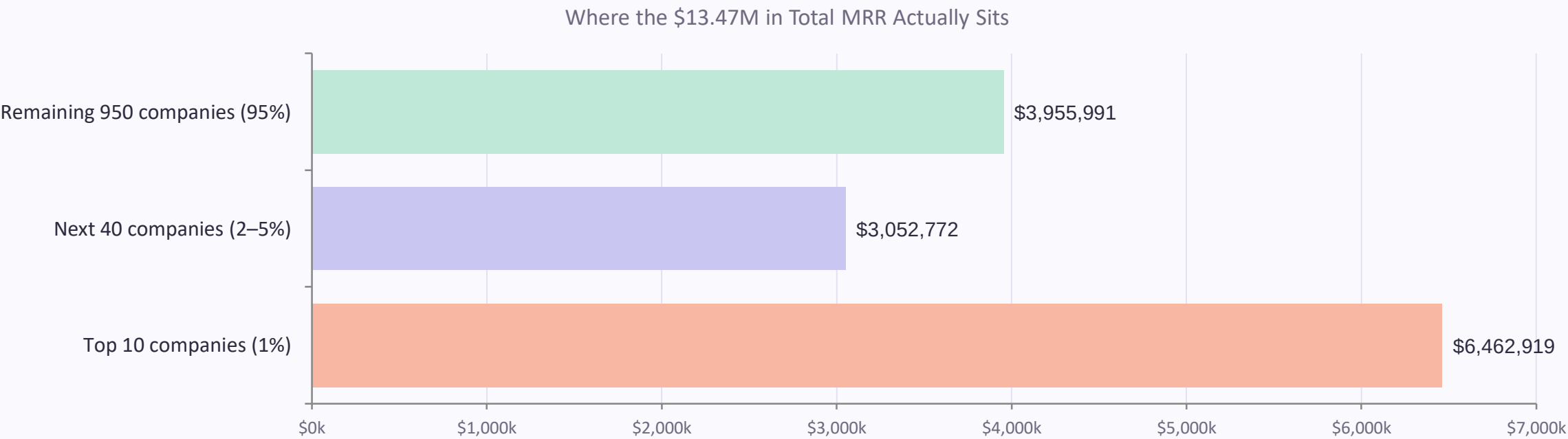
A Handful of Companies Carry the Whole Market

\$282

median MRR

vs. \$13,471

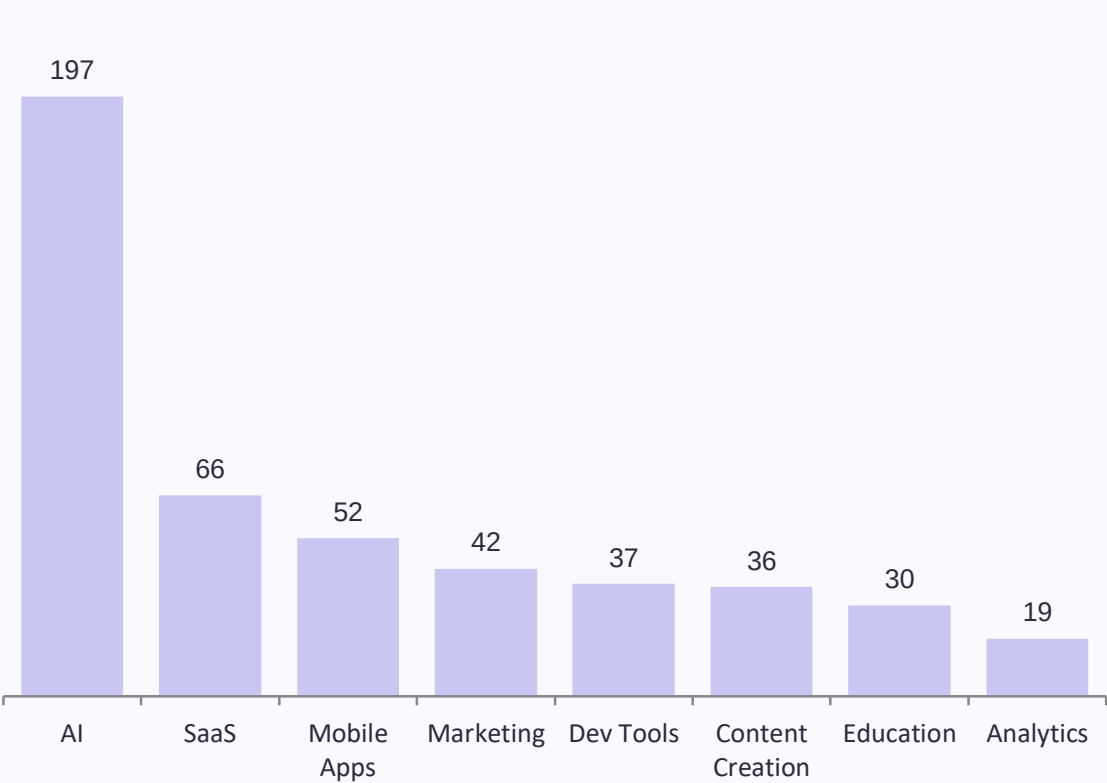
mean MRR — a 48x gap



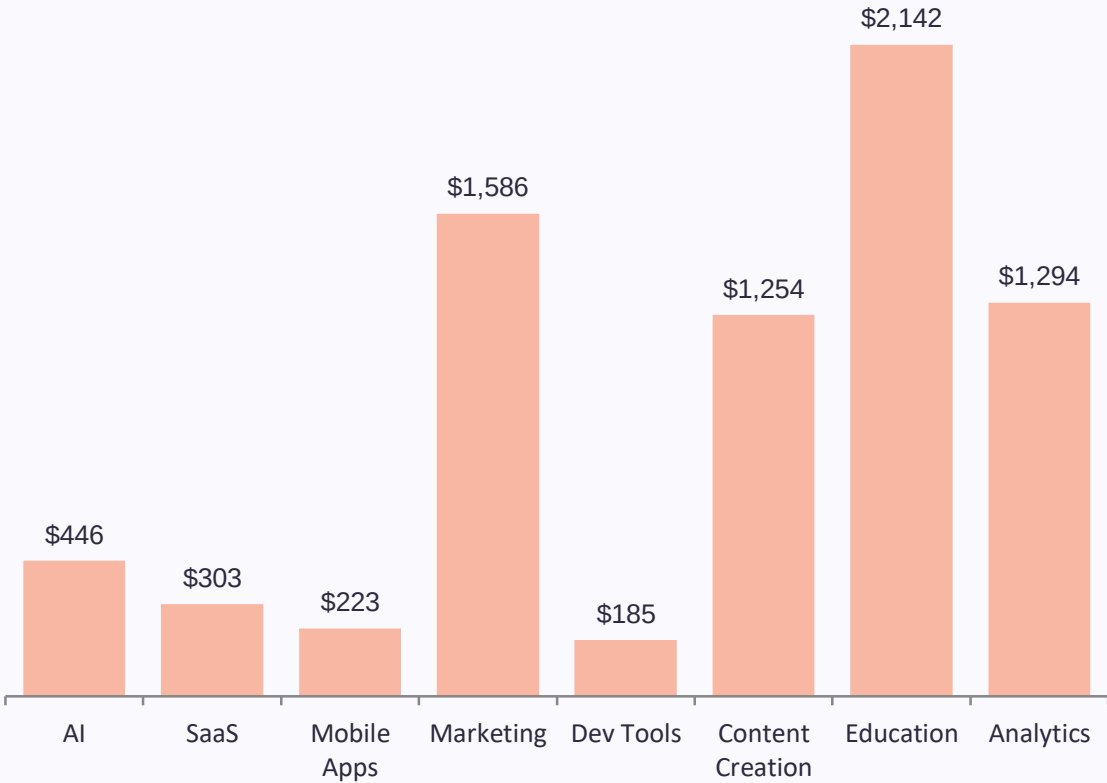
Top 1% of companies hold 48% of total MRR · top 5% hold 71%

AI Dominates Headcount — Not Monetization

Company Count by Category

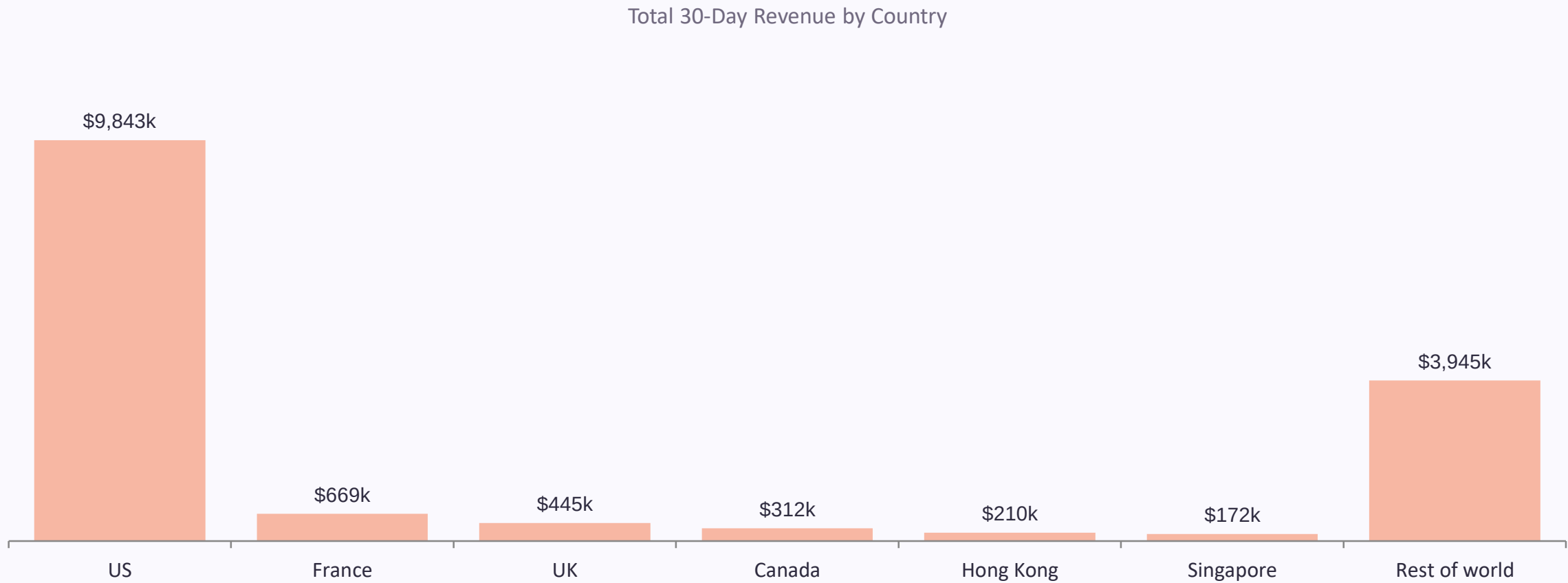


Median MRR by Category (\$)



AI is 27% of all companies but its median MRR (\$446) trails Education, Marketing, Content Creation and Analytics — the category is crowded, not uniformly profitable.

The US Punches Far Above Its Weight



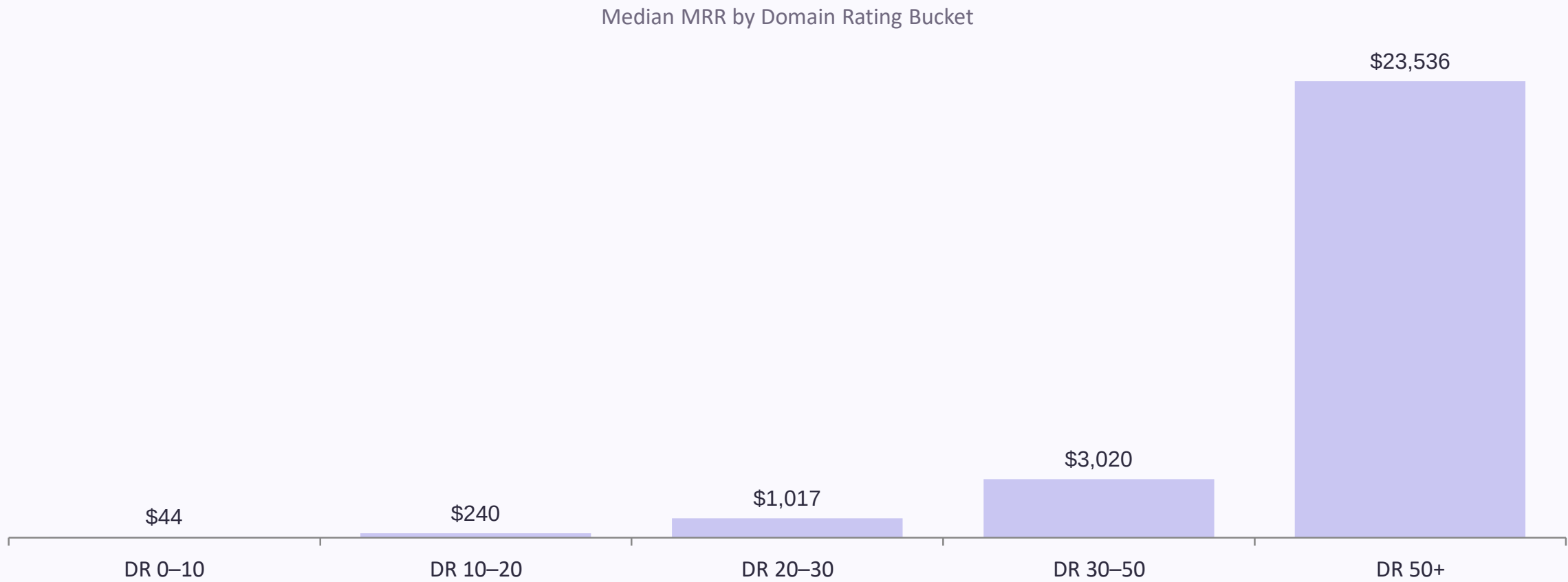
US-based companies are only 34% of companies with a known country — but they generate 63% of all 30-day revenue in the dataset (\$9.84M of \$15.6M).

B2B Monetizes Nearly 6x Better Than B2C



Fewer B2B companies exist in the sample (255 vs. 401 B2C) — but each one is worth substantially more on a typical basis. Volume and willingness-to-pay pull in opposite directions.

Domain Authority Behaves Like a Cliff, Not a Slope



Once a startup's domain rating crosses roughly 30, median MRR jumps an order of magnitude. Correlation, not proof — but a useful first-pass screen (29% of records have no domain rating at all).

Never Trust the Average Growth Rate Here

0%

median 30-day MRR growth

Half of all companies were flat or shrinking last month.

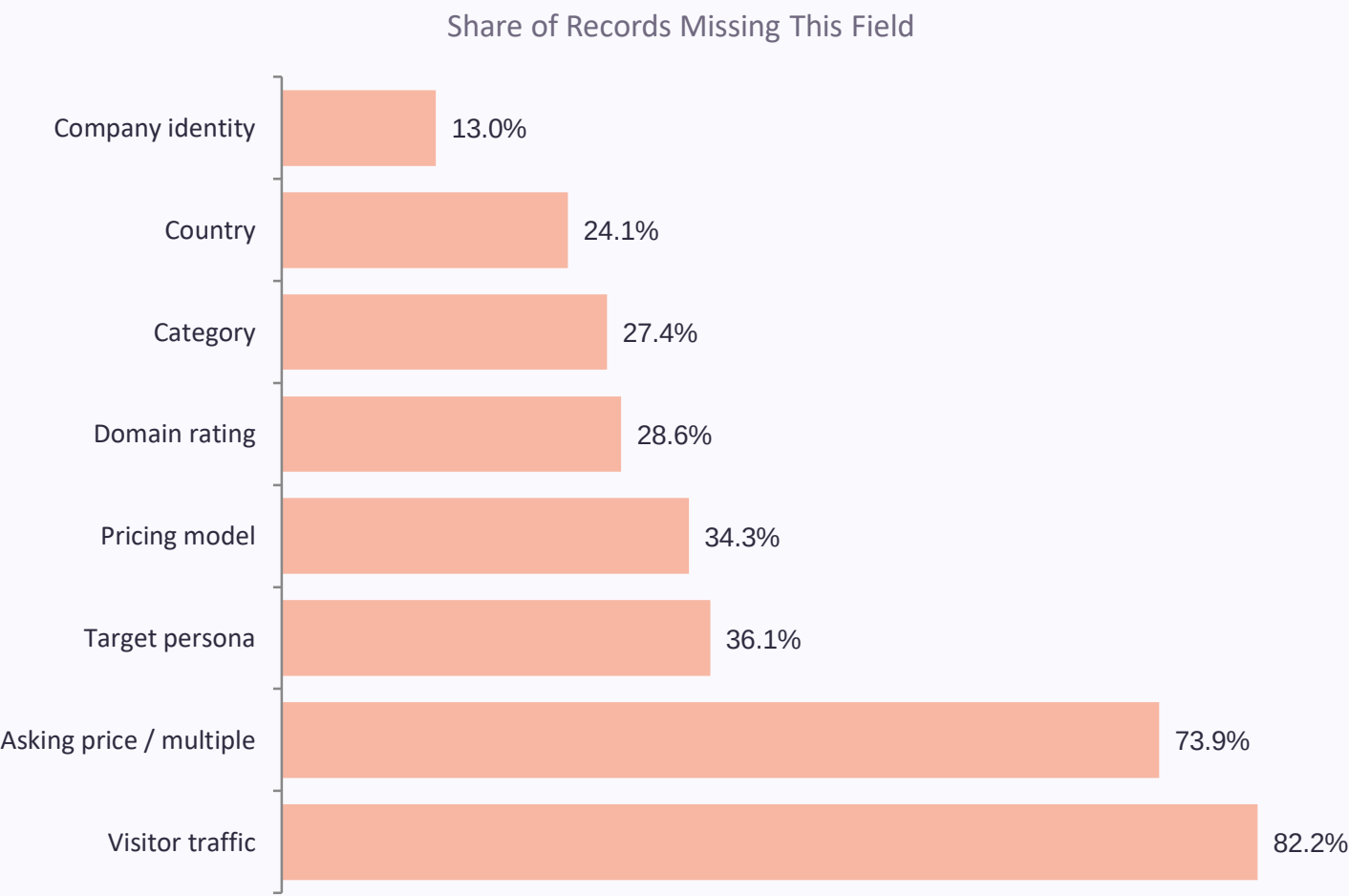
+33%

mean 30-day MRR growth

Skewed by a handful of near-zero-base spikes — one listing shows +12,983% in a month.

Any deck, memo, or pitch that quotes an average growth rate from this kind of dataset is quietly laundering a few outliers into a false market narrative. Ask for the median — and the absolute base it's measured from.

What's Missing — and Why It Matters



28.1%

of all MRR in the dataset sits inside anonymized "Stealth Company" listings

130 / 1,000

companies (13%) carry no usable name — real financials, no identity to diligence

What Buyers Are Actually Paying

262

companies listed for sale — 26% of the dataset

\$35,000

median asking price

3.2x

median implied ARR multiple, all listings

2.35x

median multiple, B2B listings only

Survivorship signal: on-sale companies have a *higher* median MRR (\$1,055) than companies not for sale (\$187). Sellers in this market disproportionately list their **working** businesses — the ones easiest to sell — not distressed ones. Multiples above ~10x in the raw data are outliers, almost certainly pre-revenue or asset-based listings, and should be excluded from any pricing benchmark.

The Market Rewards Business Model and Credibility — Not Buzz

Recurring revenue here behaves like a barbell. A small set of durable, well-indexed B2B businesses holds most of the real value, while a long tail of AI-labeled, early-stage products generates attention without cash flow. The headline growth rates and deal multiples amplify that illusion, and a meaningful slice of the market's true value stays invisible until someone asks for it directly.

48%

of all MRR sits with the top 1% of companies

5.7x

higher median MRR for B2B vs. B2C

28%

of visible MRR is inside anonymized listings

Five Moves for an Investor Screening This Market

1

Screen on two filters

Rank targets by B2B audience type + domain rating 30–plus before opening a single deck — it isolates the top decile mechanically.

2

Verify economics, not the tag

Pull unit economics and retention for any “AI” target directly — the category label alone tells you nothing about revenue quality.

3

Rebuild the growth math

Request the absolute revenue base behind every quoted growth %, then recompute the median yourself before it enters a model.

4

Ask before you skip Stealth listings

Request identity disclosure under NDA on any anonymized target worth pursuing, rather than passing on principle.

5

Price B2B deals near 2–3x ARR

Use the ~2.35x median as your sanity check; flag anything quoted above ~10x for extra diligence before you engage.